

Some Asiatic tribes used garnets as musket balls in the belief that their blood-red colour would make them more lethal



Spessartine garnet | Sometimes mistaken for hessonite in cut stones, spessartine is less rare now than in the past, due to abundant new finds. It is shown here in a brilliant-cut oval gemstone.



Inclusions add interest

Cinnamon heart | This hessonite "cinnamon stone" heart is faceted in a mixed cut, and has numerous inclusions of gas-filled bubbles, all of which have been attractively magnified by the faceting.



Hessonite garnet | Faceted in a round, mixed cut, this hessonite variety of grossular is characterised by an unusually deep and rich colouring.



Pyrope garnet | With its deep red colouring, pyrope is sometimes mistaken for ruby. This example has been faceted in a pendalogue cut.



Malaya garnet | This garnet is a mixture of pyrope and spessartine, and is often richly coloured, as can be seen in this brilliant-cut cushion gemstone.



Almandine garnet | Rich, purple-red garnets are usually regarded as the best gem-grade almandine garnets, as in this rectangular, cushion mixed-cut.